

Understanding Equality, Diversity and Inclusion in the UK Digital Research Infrastructure Community

Participant Information Sheet (PIS)

The information in this section is to help you decide whether or not you want to participate in this research study by providing a summary of key points about the study. We have included detailed information after this section.

Your participation in this survey involves sharing your opinions and experience on equality, diversity and inclusion (EDI) within the UK digital research infrastructure and large-scale compute landscape (DRI+) community. This survey is being conducted by the CAKE-CoSeC EDI Working Group.

Taking part involves completing an online survey about your experiences, views, and priorities relating to EDI. Participation is voluntary, all questions are optional, and you may stop at any time before submitting your responses.

Any personal data you choose to provide, such as your name or email address, will only be used for follow-up contact if you allow this. Survey responses will be stored securely by the University of Edinburgh and anonymised before being shared or published. All data will be deleted at the end of the CAKE project, 1st April 2028.

Introduction

We invite you to take part in our research study. Before you decide, please take time to read this information. It explains why we are doing the study and what it will involve.

You can talk to someone you trust before you decide. It's entirely your choice whether to take part. If you decide to take part, you will be asked to confirm your consent. If anything is unclear or if you have any questions, please get in touch with Eleanor Broadway (e.broadway@epcc.ed.ac.uk).

What is the research about?

This survey is designed to gather insights from members of the UK digital research infrastructure and large-scale compute landscape (DRI+) community to better understand experiences, priorities, and challenges related to equality, diversity and inclusion (EDI).

The study aims to learn directly from the community about how people engage with EDI in practice, including where they seek information or support, which topics feel most important, and what kinds of activities or resources would be most helpful. It also explores what

approaches are currently working well, where challenges remain, and what further support the community would value.

A key goal is to identify the types of support, resources and changes that would make the biggest difference in advancing EDI efforts across the UK DRI+ community. The findings will be used to align the work of the [CAKE-CoSeC EDI working group](#) with the real, lived experiences and priorities of the community it has been established to support.

This research project has been approved through the Research Ethics process at EPCC, University of Edinburgh. For further information on the Ethics process, please contact Dr Rosa Filgueira, R.Filgueira@epcc.ed.ac.uk, EPCC Research Ethics Officer

Who do we want to take part?

You are invited to take part if you are part of the UK DRI+ community in any capacity.

The CAKE–CoSeC EDI Working Group brings together a broad cross-section of the UK's Digital Research Infrastructure (DRI) landscape and its wider large-scale computing community. [CAKE](#) supports collaboration and community-building across the [DRI programme](#), with a strong emphasis on being outward-facing and welcoming new and emerging communities. [CoSeC](#) enables and supports collaborative computational research communities funded across UKRI, including Collaborative Computational Projects (CCPs) and High-End Computing (HEC) consortia.

Together, these initiatives span a diverse and evolving community. This survey is open to anyone within this space, with the aim of helping to shape an inclusive culture that supports both current members and those who may join in the future.

What will happen to me if I take part?

If you choose to take part in this study, you will be asked to complete an online, self-paced survey. The survey will cover topics including:

- Experiences and perceptions of EDI within the UK DRI+ community
- Awareness and use of existing EDI resources
- Barriers and challenges related to participation and inclusion
- Priorities for future EDI initiatives and community support

All questions in the survey are optional, and you may skip any that you prefer not to answer.

You will be asked to provide your consent for your responses to be included in the study.

You will also have the option to provide your name and email address and to select if you would like to be:

- Contacted about outputs produced from this work
- Asked to participate in future follow-up surveys run by the same group
- Contacted for future interview run by the same group

Are there any benefits in taking part?

There are no direct personal benefits to taking part in the study. However, your contribution will play an important role in shaping the future of EDI across the UK DRI+ community.

Are there any risks involved?

There are no foreseeable risks from participating in this study.

What data will be collected?

The following is an exhaustive and complete list of all the data that will be collected in the course of this study.

- Question responses
- Name (Optional)
- Email addresses (Optional)

All data will be collected by forms hosted at the University of Edinburgh, who is owning the research. All data collected is optional, including personal data. If you choose to provide your name and email address, these will only be used to enable follow-up contact in ways specified by you.

Some questions include optional free-text responses. Although we are not asking participants to provide sensitive personal information, they may choose to share personal experiences or details that could be sensitive or potentially identifiable. Participants should avoid naming individuals, teams or organisations, or including details that could identify themselves or others, unless they are comfortable doing so.

Data will be stored on the University of Edinburgh SharePoint . The data will be held in accordance with university policy on data retention. Data files will be protected by the university's two-factor authentication provided by Microsoft; laptops and desktops will be protected by fingerprint or password protection; there will be no physical data.

All outputs will be openly licensed. No personal data will feature in outputs.

All data will be destroyed by Eleanor Broadway at the end of the study (1st April 2028) by deleting it from the SharePoint site.

How will my information and personal details be protected?

Raw survey responses will only be accessible to a small number of named/approved research team members (see list at the end of this sheet). Before any findings are shared with the wider CAKE-CoSeC EDI Working Group or included in public outputs, responses will be anonymised or abstracted. If a free-text response cannot be safely anonymised, it will not be quoted or shared publicly.

Do I have to take part?

No, it is entirely up to you to decide whether or not to take part. If you decide you want to take part, you will need to confirm consent via the survey to show you have agreed to take part.

What happens if I change my mind?

You have the right to change your mind and withdraw your data without giving a reason and without your participant rights being affected. If you would like to withdraw, please email Eleanor Broadway (e.broadway@epcc.ed.ac.uk).

You may withdraw your data up until 14th October 2026. After this point, it may no longer be possible to remove your responses if they have already been anonymised and incorporated into the analysis.

What will happen to the results of the research?

The research findings will be used to guide the outputs and focus areas of the CAKE-CoSeC EDI Working Group.

They will be included in public reports from the CAKE-CoSeC EDI Working Group.

They will also be used to advise future iterations of the data collection/community outreach activities of the CAKE-CoSeC EDI Working Group.

Research findings made available in any reports or publications will not include any identifying information that can directly identify you.

Where can I get more information?

If you have any questions or you would like further information about this study then please email Eleanor Broadway (e.broadway@epcc.ed.ac.uk) or the CAKE management team at (cake@jiscmail.ac.uk) and a member of the team will respond as soon as possible.

What happens if there is a problem?

If you are concerned or unhappy about any part of the study, please contact the researchers. They will do their best to answer your questions.

- Eleanor Broadway (e.broadway@epcc.ed.ac.uk)
- Eva Fernandez Amez (eva.fernandez-amez@durham.ac.uk)
- Stephanie Thompson (s.e.m.thompson@bham.ac.uk)
- Marta Camps Santasmasas (M.CampsSantasmasas@salford.ac.uk)
- Damian Jones (damian.jones@stfc.ac.uk)

If you remain unhappy or have a complaint about any part of this study, please contact the EPCC Research Ethics Officer, Dr. Rosa Filgueira, (R.Filgueira@epcc.ed.ac.uk), University of Edinburgh.

Thank you.

Thank you for taking the time to read the information sheet and considering taking part in the research.